

REASONS FOR THE SURGE

The demand for MBA is growing in the globalised world and the management graduates chant the social responsibility mantra



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Known as the millennial generation, this new group of entrepreneurs is now seeking an MBA, primarily because it is motivated to start, or work in businesses beneficial to the society. Evidence of this growing interest is demonstrated by the expansion of the Net Impact conferences. First developed in 1995, Net Impact is an international non-profit organisation, committed to making a positive impact on society through business. In November, the 13th Net Impact Conference will be held at the Wharton School, where over 1,800 students, government and NGO representatives from across the world, will discuss corporate social responsibility and social entrepreneurship.

Senior academics at prominent business schools across the globe have noticed that an increasing number of applicants possess a strong record of involvement in the community and a genuine interest in pursuing careers that allow them to give back to the society.

If you are interested in becoming an international manager you may soon join the ranks of qualified MBAs. But business schools are not all the

same. You need to ensure that your choice of school matches your personal requirements. Students are choosing MBA programmes on the basis of a school's reputation followed by success in placements, return on financial investment, availability of scholarships and the range of subjects the school specialises in. The ranking of the school is only the sixth most important factor.

All rankings are of limited value because the factor weightings don't reflect the needs of the majority of applicants. Ultimately, the main problem with rankings is that they pretend to make objective something that is fundamentally a very personal and subjective thing. Users need to delve into each ranking and identify the elements that can provide useful information or insight into schools that may interest them.

It is also becoming common for business development and technology managers to take an MBA to help reach the next step in their career. Between 2005 and 2008, survey results on recruiter research indicated a resurgence in employers' demand for MBAs (by 40 per cent), exceeding previously recorded levels.

However, MBA demand amongst employers is tied to the strength of the global economy. A global recession would negatively impact employment opportunities. India is unlikely to experience a recession any time soon, and apart from China, employers recruiting for India have reported the largest percentage increases in salaries offered to MBAs.

For many candidates, the geographic and functional flexibility offered by the degree is a route to diversify risk away from the country, industry or function in times of recession. With an MBA, it becomes easier to make up to two out of the three big career changes, either in geography, function or industry, but rarely can someone change all three. But, in a recession, big career changes become harder and an MBA is likely to be simply a route to a career progression.

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The writer is the editor of topmba.com and managing director, QS World MBA



PRASHANT CHAUDHARY